



DREAM SQUAT
Leading Experts in Crafting Your Dream Practice

BRAND AND MARKETING

12 Week Pre-Launch Planner

Fill your diary before you open, not after

www.dreamsquats.co.uk



The most expensive mistake in a squat build is the six weeks after opening when the practice is beautiful, the team is on payroll, and the phone is not ringing. Almost all of it is avoidable. This planner runs your marketing while the builders are still in, so your first month is a booking exercise rather than a marketing one.

HOW TO USE THIS WORKSHEET

- Set your opening date first, then work backwards. Week 12 is twelve weeks before you open.
- Assign an owner and a date to every task. Tasks without owners do not happen during a build.
- Section 3 is the part most practices skip and it is worth more than everything else combined.
- Track the numbers in Section 5 weekly. Registered interest before opening is your real launch metric.





THE PRINCIPLE

Why sequential marketing fails

The instinct is tidy. Build the practice, then market the practice. It is completely wrong, because patient acquisition has a lag.

Someone sees your practice, thinks about it, checks your reviews, discusses it at home, and books three weeks later. If your marketing starts on opening day, your first meaningful volume arrives in month two, and you have burned four to six weeks of full running costs waiting for it.

Start twelve weeks out and that lag has already happened by the time your doors open.

Target opening date	
Week 12 starts	
Monthly running cost once open	
Cost of a two month slow start	

That last figure is what this planner is worth to you. On a practice with £25,000 of monthly running costs, bringing breakeven forward by two months is £50,000. It is the highest return activity in the entire build and it costs a fraction of what you are spending on cabinetry.



**SECTION ONE****The twelve week sequence****Weeks 12 to 10: Identity and infrastructure**

One job this fortnight: become findable, and start capturing names

Task	Owner	Due	Done
Practice name confirmed and checked for availability			
Logo, colours and basic brand assets complete			
Domain registered and business email live			
Single page website live: who, where, when opening, and a register interest form			
Google Business Profile created and verification started			
Social accounts claimed on all platforms, even ones you will not use yet			
Enquiry capture tested end to end, including where the notification goes			
Decide who owns enquiries and what the response time standard is			

Weeks 10 to 8: Local presence

Your unit is advertising space you are already paying for. Use it.

Task	Owner	Due	Done
Branded hoardings up on the unit with website address and QR code			
Window vinyls or coming soon signage installed			
Start posting the build: site photos, progress, decisions			
Announce the practice on local community groups and pages			
Photograph everything as you go, because you cannot go back for it			
Register with local directories and the NHS or private listings you will use			

**Weeks 8 to 6: The people and the partners**

One job this fortnight: become findable, and start capturing names

Task	Owner	Due	Done
Clinician profiles written and photographed			
Founder or principal story published			
Team introduction posts scheduled			
List twenty complementary local businesses (gyms, salons, nurseries, cafes, aesthetics)			
Reciprocal offer designed and approach email sent to all twenty			
Local press or community newsletter contacted			
Fee guide finalised and signed off			

Weeks 6 to 4: The offer and the list

Open a founding patient list. Scarcity works here because it is real: month one genuinely has finite space.

Task	Owner	Due	Done
Founding patient offer designed (a position, not a discount)			
Landing page live for the founding patient list			
Paid search live for high intent local terms			
Local paid social live with a radius around the practice			
Leaflet or direct mail to immediate catchment if using			
Email sequence written for everyone who registers interest			
Booking system live and tested			

**Weeks 4 to 2: Convert the list**

This is the step most practices skip, and it is worth more than everything above it combined.

Task	Owner	Due	Done
Call every person who registered interest, by phone, not email			
Start booking appointments into the opening fortnight			
Confirm bookings with reminders and a what to expect message			
Team trained on phone handling and enquiry response scripts			
Response time standard tested with a mystery call			
Review request process agreed before the first patient arrives			

Weeks 2 to 0: Launch

Open with names in the diary and the local businesses on your side.

Task	Owner	Due	Done
Opening event planned and invitations sent			
Local businesses and partners invited			
Opening week diary reviewed: how many booked, how many gaps			
Photography and video booked for the finished practice			
Launch announcement scheduled across all channels			
Day one enquiry rota agreed so nothing goes unanswered			

**SECTION TWO****The founding patient offer**

Design a position, not a discount. A discount attracts people who leave when the discount does.

What the offer is	
How many places (be specific and honest)	
What they get that later patients will not	
Deadline	
Why this is genuinely limited	
What you want them to do next	

SECTION THREE**Enquiry response: the number that decides everything**

Everything in Section 1 is acquisition. Acquisition is wasted if enquiries sit unanswered. When I mystery shopped dental practices the pattern was consistent: enquiries unanswered for days, voicemails not returned, web forms landing in an inbox nobody owned.

A practice with a mediocre campaign and a five minute response time beats a practice with a brilliant campaign and a two day response time, every single time.

Who owns enquiries during opening hours	
Who owns them outside opening hours	
Response time standard (phone)	
Response time standard (web form)	
Response time standard (social message)	



What happens when that person is at lunch	
Where enquiries are logged	
Who checks nothing was missed, and when	
Follow up sequence if there is no answer	

SABA'S NOTE

Before you spend a single pound on marketing, mystery shop yourself. Get a friend to call, fill in the web form and send a message on Instagram, then time how long each one takes to get a real human response. Whatever that number is, it is your ceiling. No campaign will outperform it.





SECTION FOUR

Budget

Task	Budget	Actual	Variance
Brand identity and assets			
Website build			
Photography and video			
Signage and hoardings			
Print and direct mail			
Paid search			
Paid social			
Launch event			
Contingency			
TOTAL			

SECTION FIVE

Weekly tracker

Track these every week from week 12. Registered interest before opening is the only launch metric that matters.

Metric	W12	W10	W8	W6	W4	W2
Registered interest (cumulative)						
Website visitors						
Enquiries received						
Average response time						
Appointments booked						
Social followers						
Spend to date						
Cost per registered interest						



The target: enough registered interest by week 2 that your opening fortnight diary is already half booked. If it is not, do not open later. Push harder on Section 3, because the names are usually already there and nobody has called them.

WHAT NEXT

You have the worksheet. Now get the rest.

This is one of eighteen brand and marketing templates. The website brief, pricing sheet, patient journey scripts, enquiry response scripts, launch event plan, review generation system and recall campaign are all in the Club.

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THE 90-DAY DREAM SQUAT PROGRAMME

Site, finance, CQC, brand, systems and launch, done with you by the team that build three practices. Capped cohorts.

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